

DATA ANALYSIS · 1,000 INDIE & BOOTSTRAPPED STARTUPS

What 1,000 Startups Reveal About Building Real Revenue

An evidence-based read of the TrustMRR dataset — where revenue concentrates, what separates B2B from B2C, and which metrics actually predict MRR.

1,000

companies tracked

\$13.5M

combined MRR

60+

countries represented

Revenue Is Winner-Take-Most

\$282

Median company MRR

\$13,472

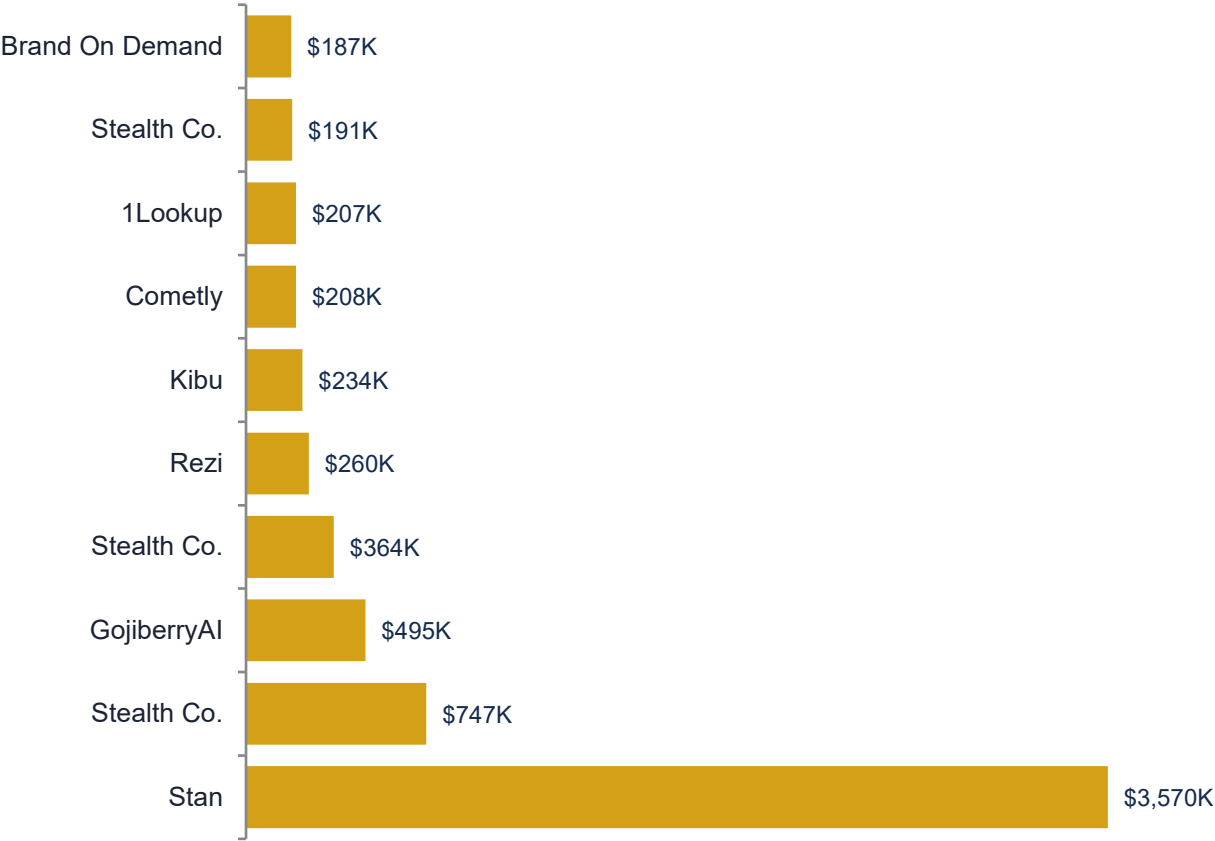
Mean company MRR — 48x the median

48%

of all \$13.5M combined MRR sits with just the top 10 companies (top 1% of the dataset)

A single company — Stan, at \$3.57M MRR — earns more than the bottom ~850 companies in the dataset combined.

Top 10 Companies by MRR (USD)



Most Companies Are Still Pre-Traction

10.9%

of companies report \$0 revenue in the last 12 months

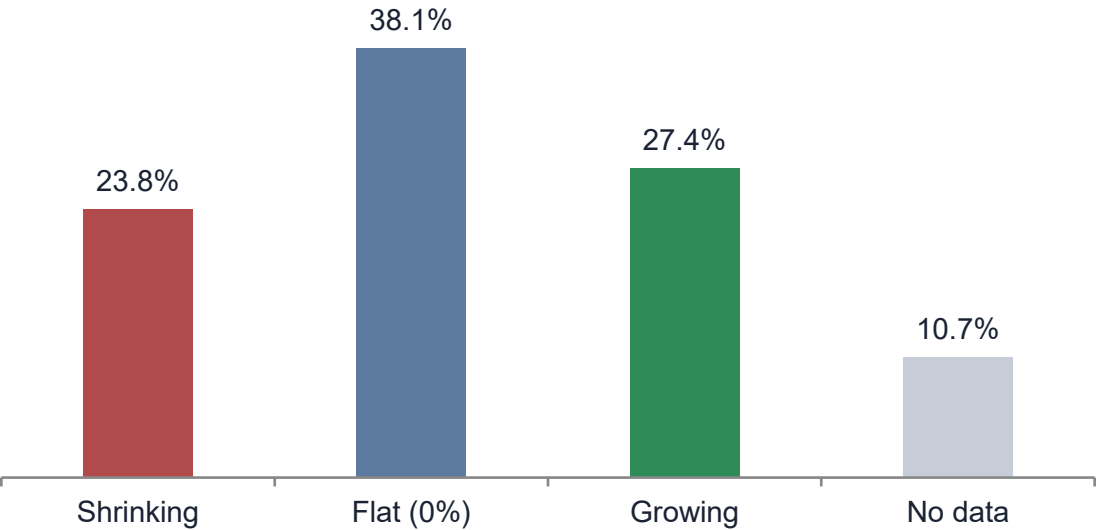
21.1%

have zero active paying subscriptions

Growth Is a Coin Flip

Median 30-day MRR growth across the dataset is exactly 0%. Roughly as many companies are shrinking (23.8%) as are growing (27.4%) — there's no default trajectory once a company launches.

30-Day MRR Growth — Split



24

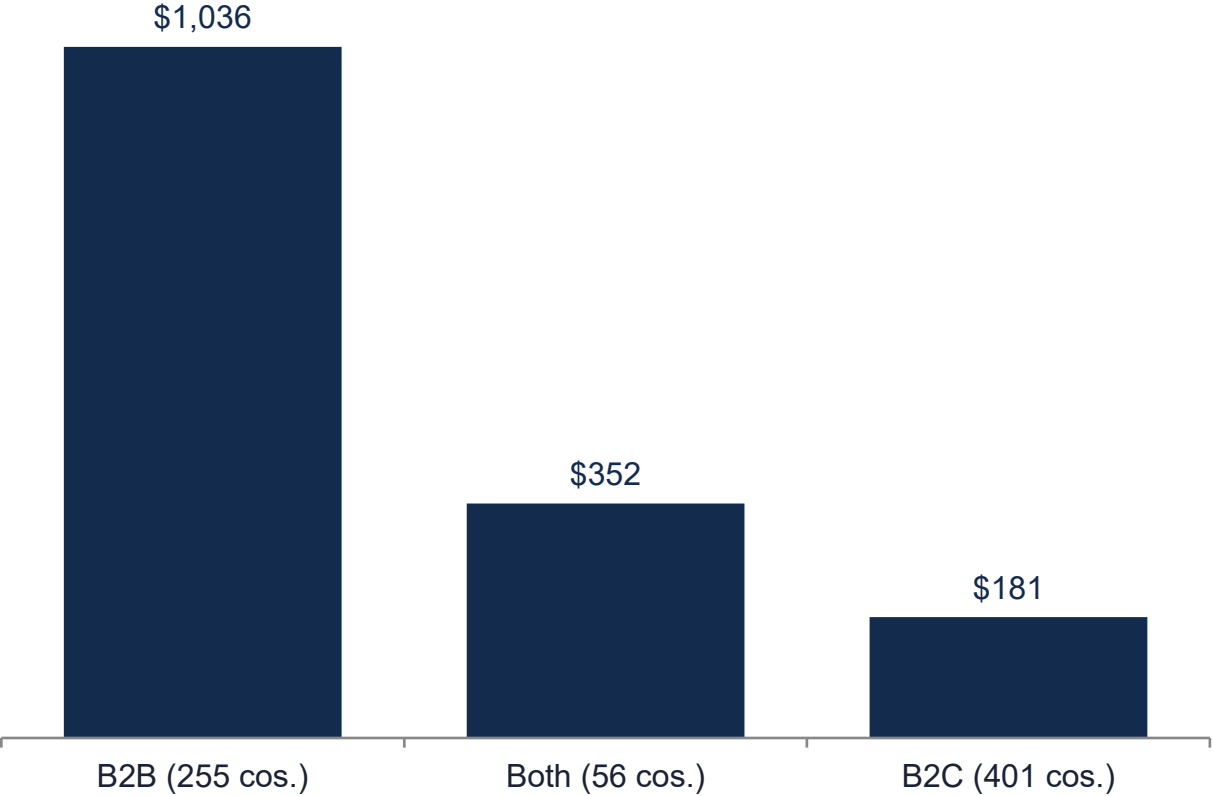
companies grew MRR by more than 100% in 30 days

3

companies saw MRR collapse to zero (-100%) in 30 days

Takeaway: traction is fragile and non-linear even after launch — sustained growth is the exception, not the norm.

B2B Commands a 5.7x Premium Over B2C



\$1,036 vs \$181

Median MRR: B2B companies vs B2C companies

401 vs 255

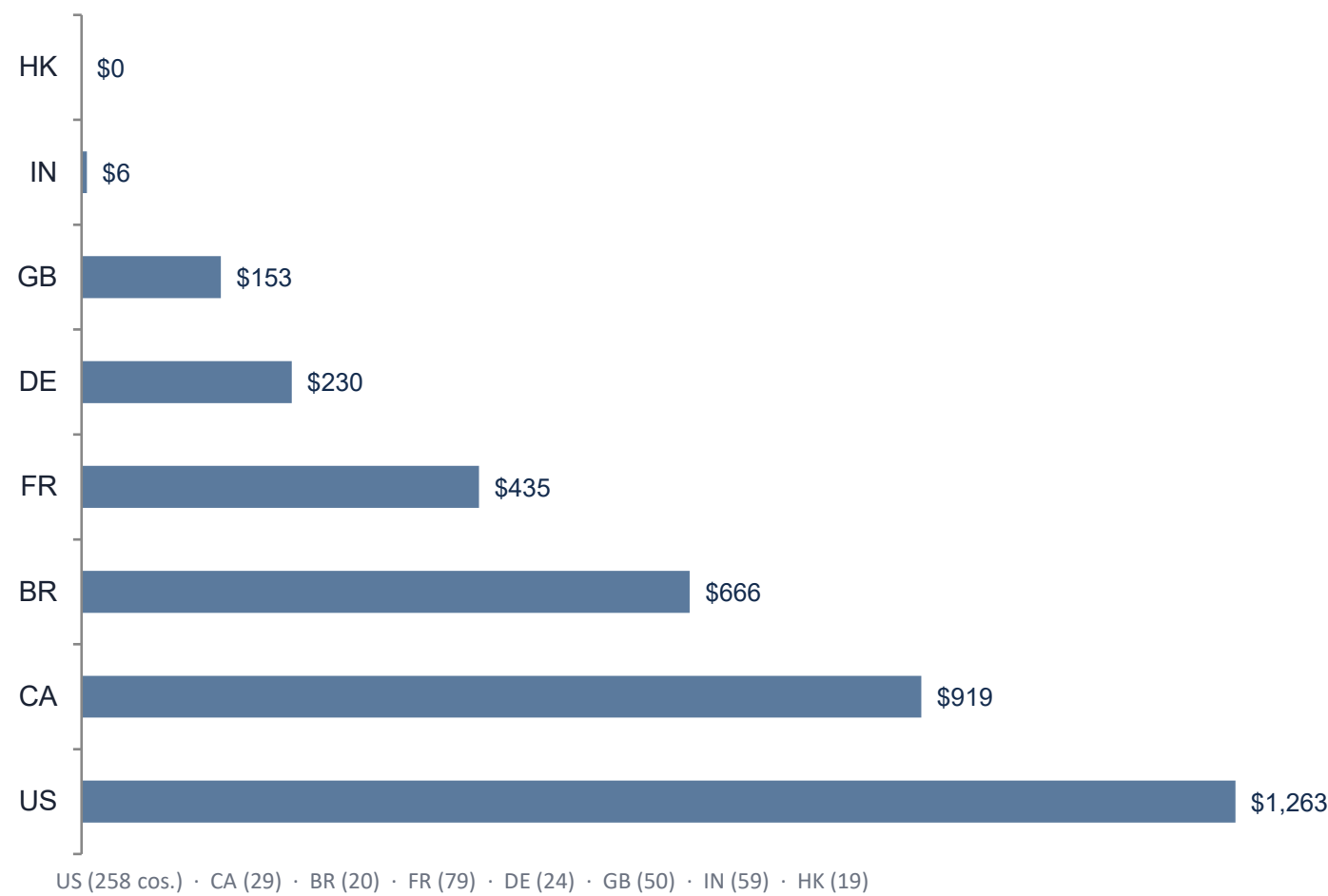
B2C has more companies in the dataset than B2B

Reading the gap

Despite B2C outnumbering B2B by 1.6x, the typical B2B company earns 5.7x more MRR. "Both" audiences land in between — broadening beyond a single buyer type doesn't automatically capture B2B-level pricing power.

Where the Revenue Actually Is

Median MRR by Top Country (company count in parentheses)



India Spotlight

\$5.97

Median MRR, 59
cos.

14/59

at \$0 revenue

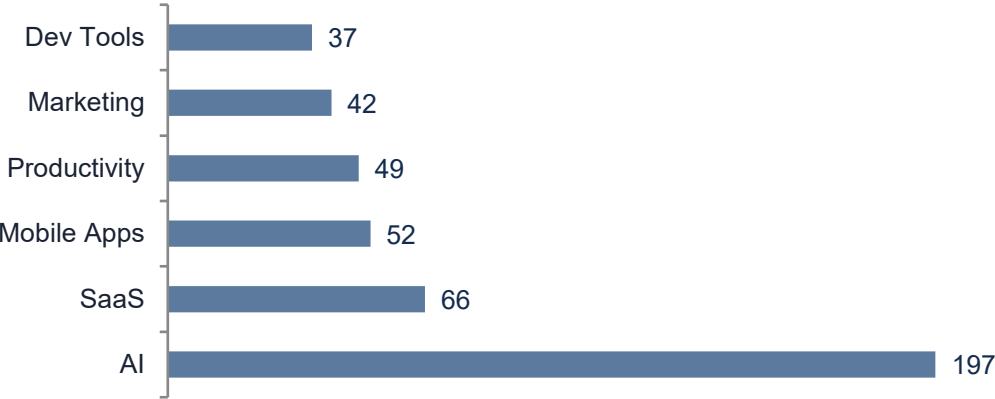
India's mean MRR (\$2,655) is 445x its median — one of the widest gaps of any country in the dataset.

Supergrow alone (Social Media, \$79,479 MRR) accounts for 50.7% of all Indian MRR in the dataset — more than the other 58 Indian companies combined.

Top India by MRR: Supergrow \$79.5K · Web3Forms \$33.0K · MagicSlides.app \$13.5K

AI Dominates by Volume, Not by Economics

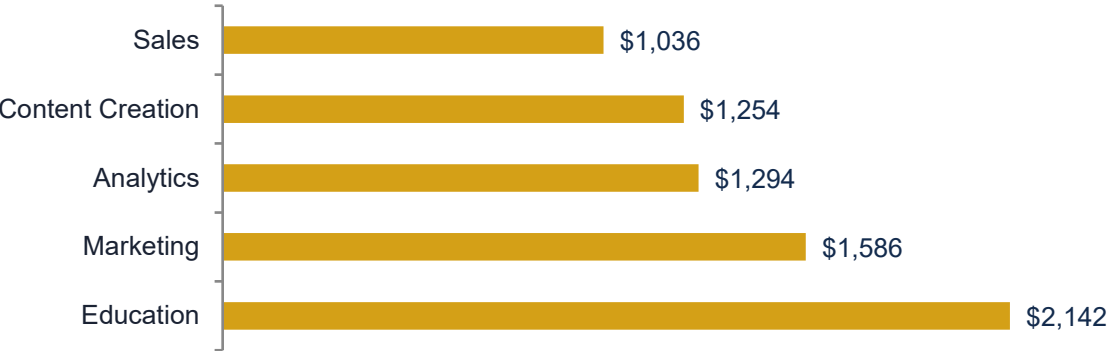
Company Count (Top Categories)



AI: \$446 median MRR

197 companies (largest category by far), yet ranks below Education, Marketing, Analytics, Content Creation and Sales on median MRR

Median MRR (Categories with 10+ companies)



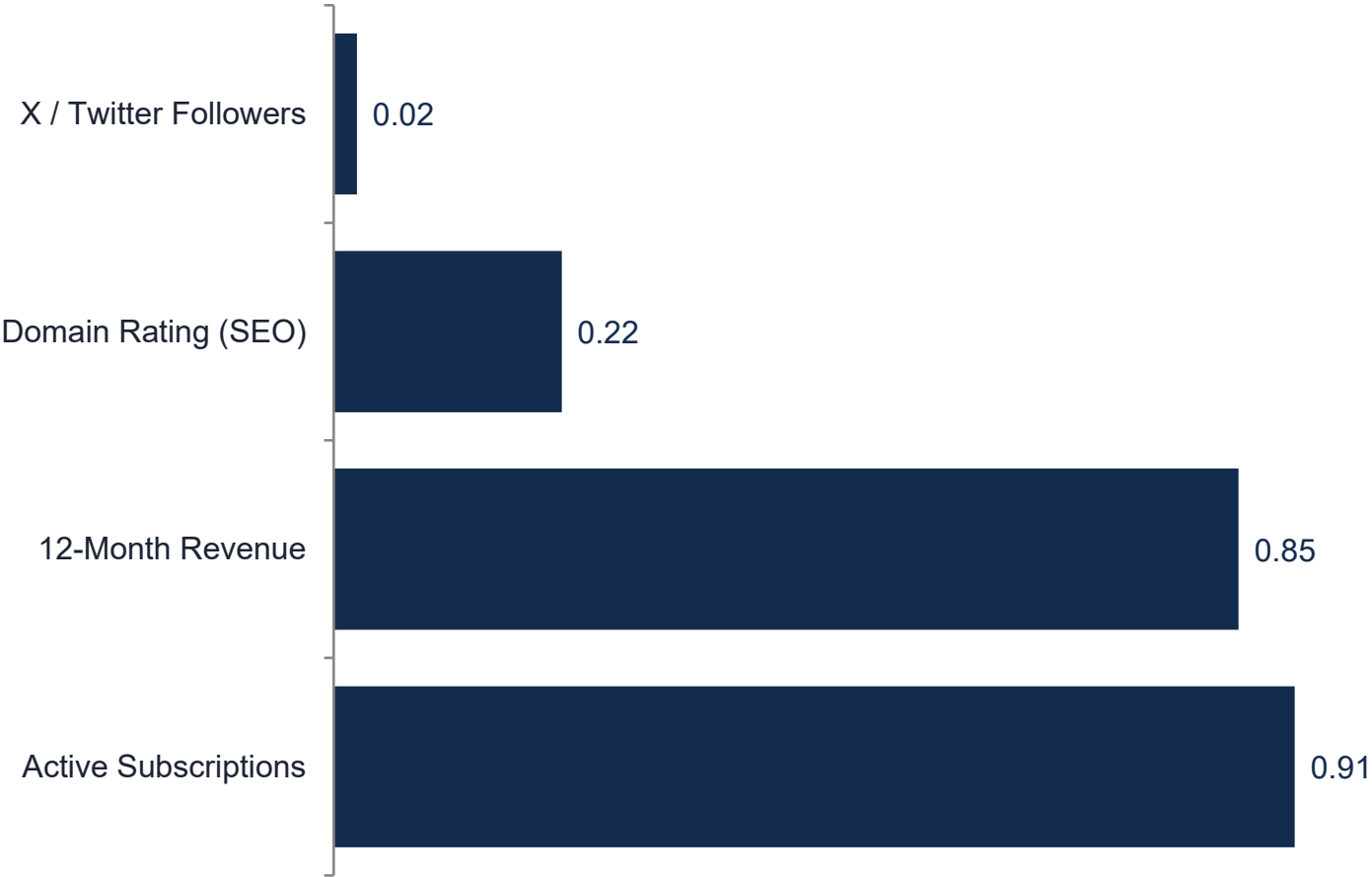
Productivity: \$42 median MRR

49 companies — the lowest median of any major category, despite steady founder interest in the space

Reading this chart

Crowded categories aren't necessarily lucrative ones. Education, Marketing and Analytics carry far fewer entrants but noticeably higher typical revenue per company.

Followers Don't Pay the Bills — Subscribers Do



$r = 0.91$

Active subscriptions is the strongest single predictor of MRR in the dataset

$r = 0.02$

X/Twitter follower count shows almost no relationship with MRR

So what to track

Subscriber count and trailing revenue move with MRR; social reach and domain authority barely do. Audience size is not a proxy for monetization.

What This Means If You're Building

26.2%

of companies (262) are listed for sale

2.3x

median revenue multiple among listed companies

\$35,000

median asking price among companies for sale

Four takeaways from the data

- 1 **Revenue is winner-take-most.** Top 10 companies hold 48% of all MRR — being merely "in the market" isn't enough; category leadership compounds.
- 2 **B2B monetizes 5.7x better than B2C at the median.** Same founder effort, structurally higher revenue ceiling — worth weighing before defaulting to a consumer product.
- 3 **Subscriber count predicts revenue; followers don't.** $r=0.91$ for active subscriptions vs $r=0.02$ for X followers — audience-building alone doesn't convert to MRR.
- 4 **A single outlier can define a whole cohort.** One company (Supergrow) is 50.7% of all Indian MRR in this dataset — sample-level conclusions need a wide base before generalizing.